The label is not the business.

Where revenue actually concentrates in 1,000 verified indie software companies — and why “AI” does not predict it

Prepared for founders evaluating acquisitions · Session 3, AI for Business: The Operating Stack

Every figure recomputed from the source file · n = 1,000 listings × 29 fields

TrustMRR verifies the money columns and nothing else.

Founders connect a payment-provider API key, so revenue and subscription figures cannot be self-reported. Everything used to describe the business still is. 1,000 listings, 29 fields.

Verified through the payment API

30-day, 3-month, 12-month and all-time revenue

Monthly recurring revenue

Active subscriptions

30-day revenue and MRR growth

Payment provider

Declared by the founder or scraped

Company name — 130 listings publish none

Country, category, market tags

Audience type, pricing model, persona

Asking price and sale status

X followers, domain rating, site visitors

Every claim in this deck rests on the left column. The right column is used only to slice it, and its gaps are stated wherever they matter.

Source: AI_In_Business_S3_Trust_MRR.xlsx, sheet “Data”, 1,000 rows × 29 columns. No external data used anywhere in this deck.

Read every figure here as a median. The mean describes eleven companies.

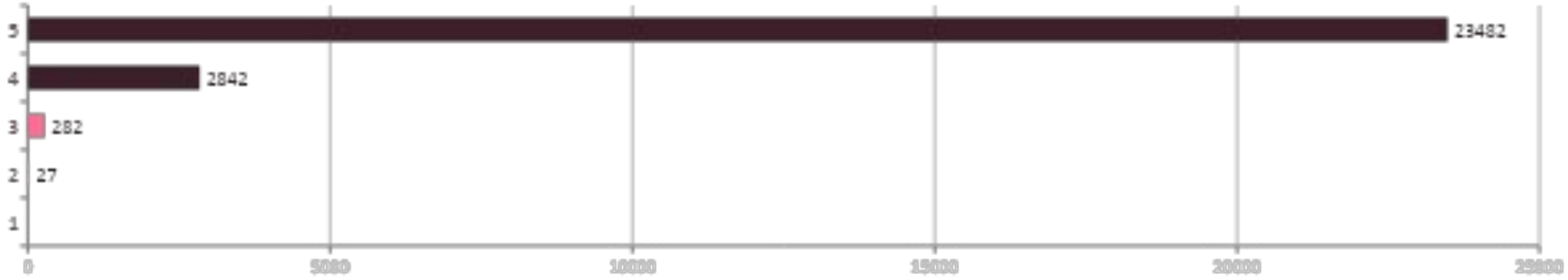
Mean MRR is $13,472; median MRR is $282 — a 48x gap produced by a handful of outliers at the top.

$282

Median MRR · median 12-month revenue $3,069 · median 16 subscriptions

$13,472

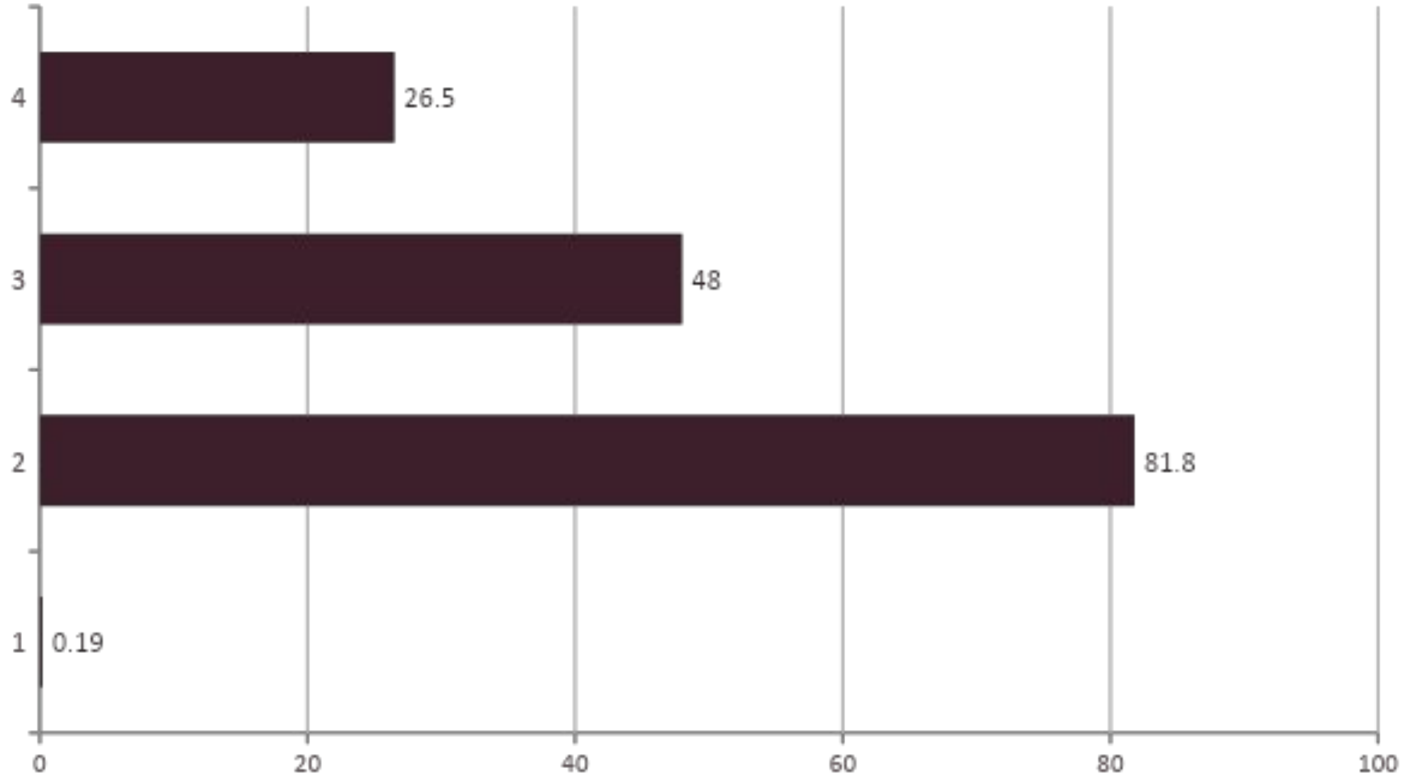
Mean MRR · the top 100 listings hold 81.8% of all revenue in the file



Source: mrr_usd, all 1,000 rows. Fifths cut on mrr_usd rank. The bottom fifth's median is exactly $0 — 197 listings report zero MRR and zero active subscriptions.

91 of these 1,000 companies hold 80% of the revenue. One holds 26.5%.

Total verified MRR is $13,471,682. The largest single listing, Stan, reports $3,569,654 MRR and 101,590 subscriptions on its own.



91

listings account for 80% of all verified MRR in the file

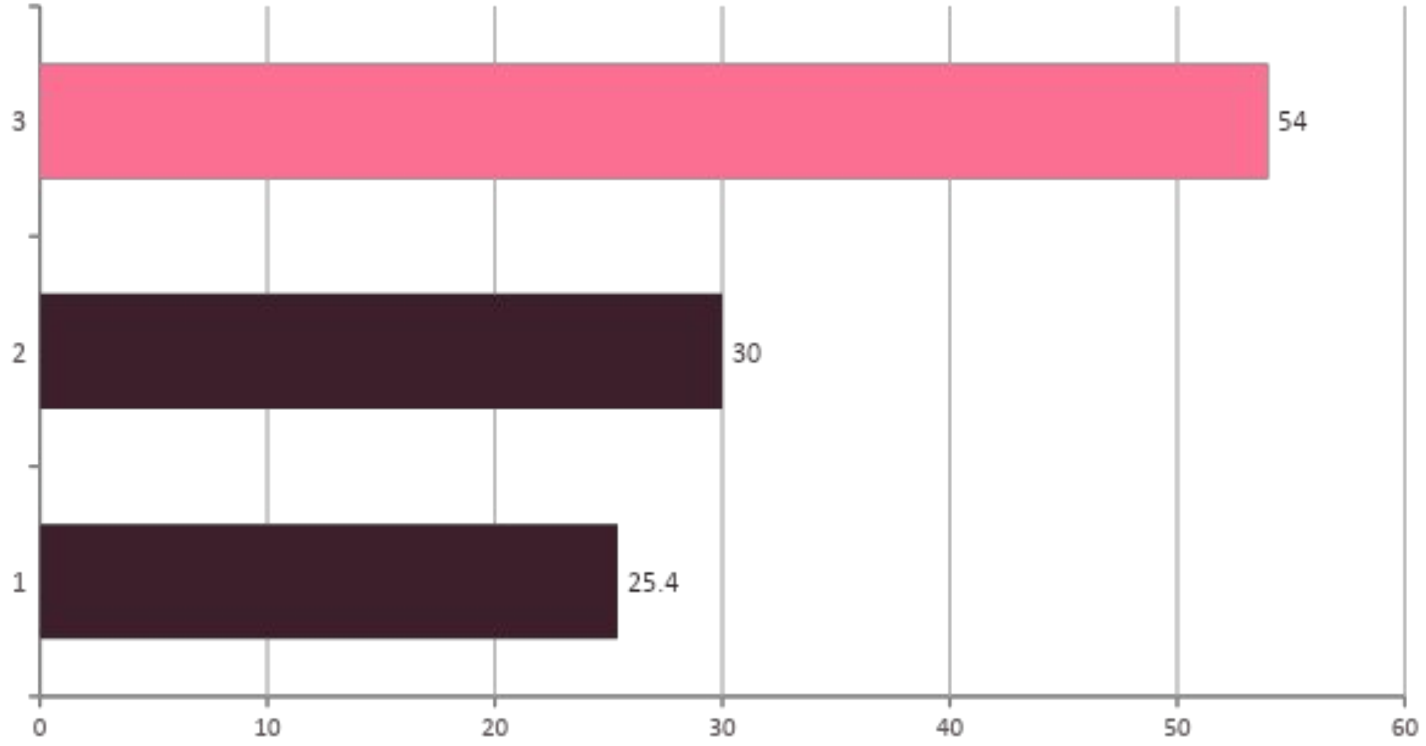
$25,073

is the combined monthly revenue of the bottom 500 listings — 0.19%

Source: mrr_usd, all 1,000 rows, no filter. Cohorts ranked descending on mrr_usd.

Half of this market calls itself AI. Under a third of the top 100 is.

AI appears on 392 of the 726 listings that carry any market tag. It appears on 30 of the 100 highest-revenue listings and accounts for 25.4% of total MRR.



54% → 30%

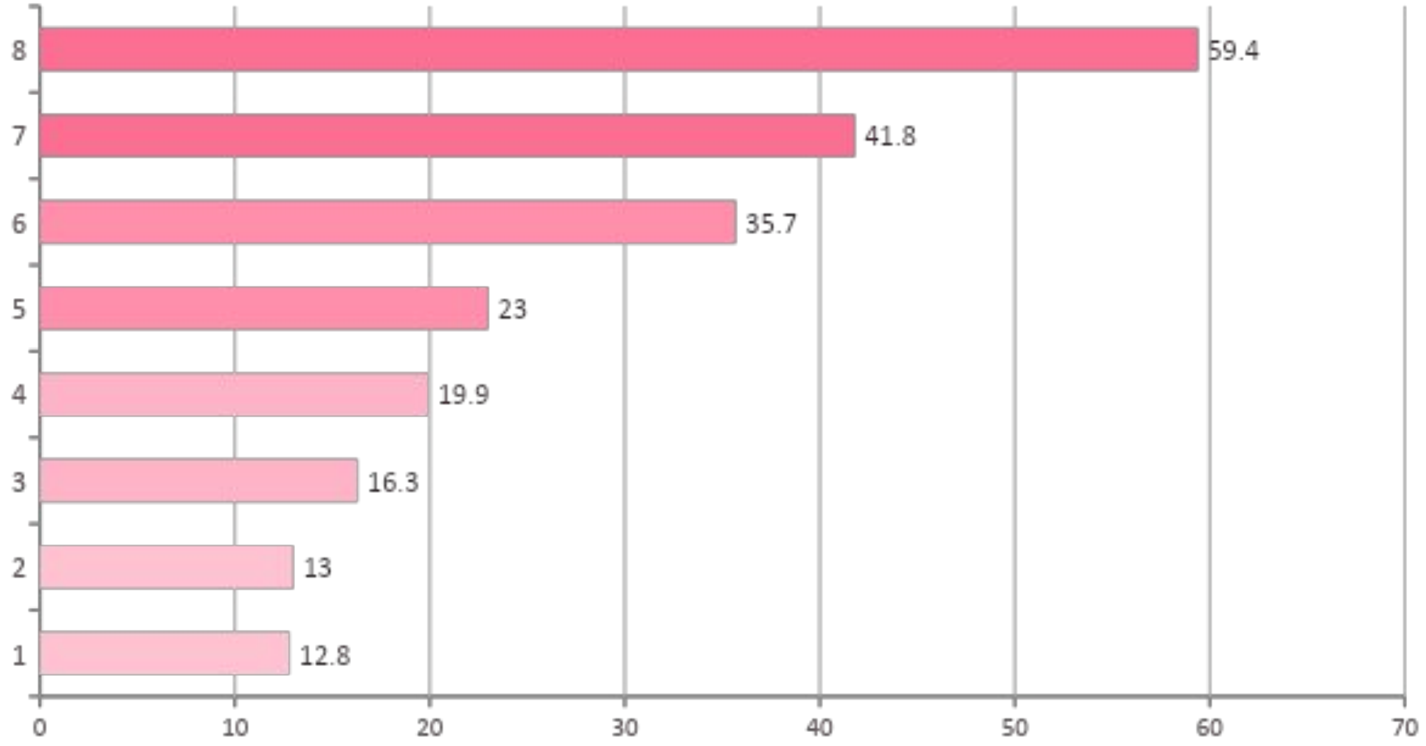
AI is over-represented in the population and under-represented at the top. If the label carried an advantage, the second figure would exceed the first.

It does not follow that AI companies earn less — median AI MRR is $430 against $268 for tagged non-AI listings. The label tracks slightly better revenue, not the concentration of it.

Source: markets_json, 726 tagged rows (274 carry no tags), and mrr_usd, all 1,000 rows. Shares of tagged listings are % of the 726 tagged rows.

Not one of the 392 AI listings is only an AI company.

Every listing tagged AI carries at least one other market tag. AI rows average 3.94 tags against 3.25 for tagged non-AI rows.



0

listings out of 392 carry the AI tag alone.

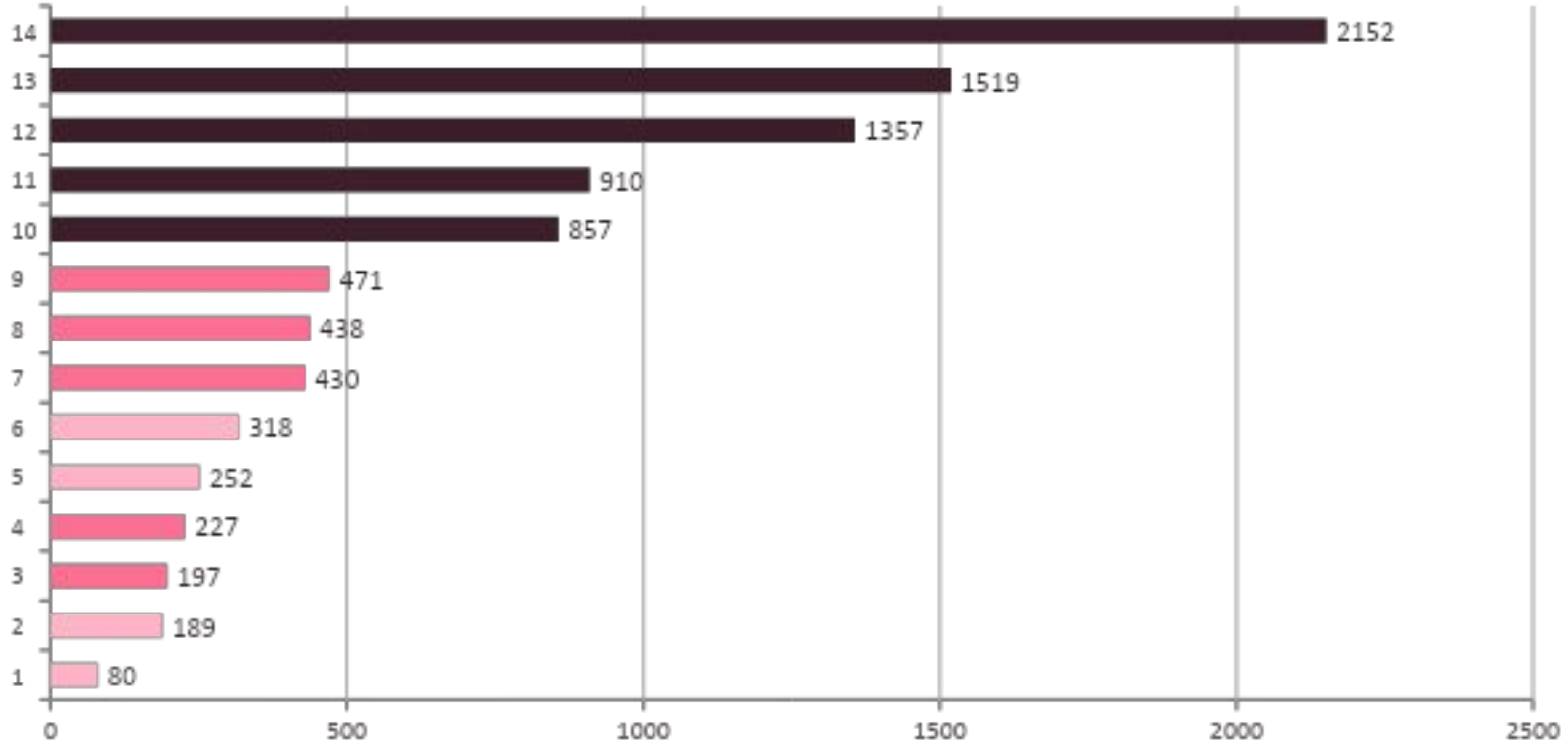
AI is applied on top of an existing product category — most often SaaS, which 59.4% of AI listings also claim.

For diligence this means the AI label describes an implementation detail. The category underneath it is what you are actually buying.

Source: markets_json, the 392 rows containing the AI tag. Tags are self-applied and overlapping, so percentages sum above 100%.

The labels founders use most are the labels attached to the least revenue.

Median MRR by market tag, tags applied to at least 15 listings. The whole-file median is $282.



Highlighted: the five most-applied tags

SaaS is applied 437 times and pays a median $438. AI is applied 392 times and pays $430. Productivity (275) and Mobile Apps (195) sit at $197 and $227 — below the $282 whole-file median.

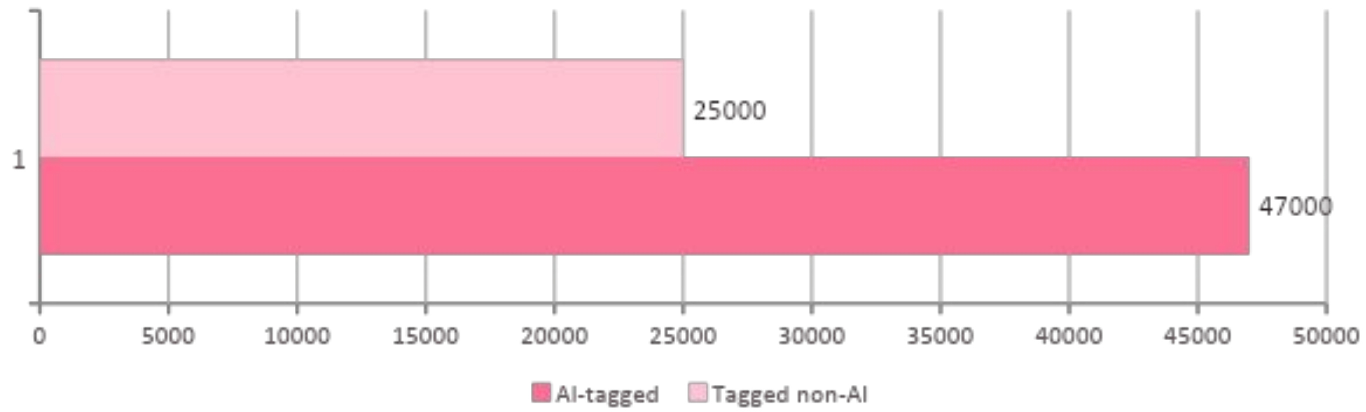
Sales and Customer Support are applied 42 times each and pay $2,152 and $1,519.

Do not use means here. Marketplace's mean MRR is $14,913 against a median of $326, on 17 listings.

Source: markets_json, 726 tagged rows, 31 distinct tags. Tags applied to fewer than 15 listings excluded: IoT & Hardware (2), News & Magazines (2), Crypto & Web3 (3), Green Tech (3), Legal (5), Recruiting & HR (11), Travel (11), Community (14).

Sellers ask 88% more for an AI listing, on a lower multiple.

Among listings for sale: median asking price $47,000 for AI-tagged against $25,000 for tagged non-AI, on median multiples of 2.3x and 2.8x.



2.3x

median multiple on AI listings, against 2.8x for tagged non-AI

30.6%

of AI listings are for sale, against 26.6% of non-AI

What a buyer is paying for

AI listings do carry more revenue — median MRR $430 against $268 — but the asking price rises faster than the revenue does, which is what compresses the multiple.

Combined with slide 06, the premium attaches to a tag that every one of these companies shares with at least one other category.

The practical test: strip the AI label from the listing and ask what you would pay for what remains.

Source: on_sale, asking_price_usd, revenue_multiple, markets_json, mrr_usd. 262 listings for sale, 261 with a price. Medians throughout.

Screen on the verified columns. Ignore the positioning.

Each test below maps to a field that cannot be self-reported.

Active subscriptions	Correlates with MRR at 0.90. The single best available proxy for whether a business has customers rather than a launch.
30-day vs 12-month revenue	Equal in 641 of 1,000 listings, meaning no history beyond a year. Underwrite on the 12-month figure.
MRR growth over 30 days	Flat at exactly 0.0% for 381 of the 893 listings that report it. Treat zero as a red flag, not as stability.
Market tags and category	Self-applied, overlapping, blank on 274 listings, and uncorrelated with concentration. Use for search, never for valuation.
X followers	Correlates with MRR at 0.17. Audience size tells you almost nothing about revenue.

Source: active_subscriptions, revenue_30d_usd, revenue_12m_usd, revenue_all_time_usd, mrr_growth_30d_pct, markets_json, category, x_followers. Correlations are Spearman on pairwise complete cases.

What this data cannot tell you.

274 of 1,000 listings carry no category or market tag, so every share in this deck is a share of labelled listings, not of the market.

130 listings publish no company name, and they hold 28.1% of all MRR — the richest cohort is the least described.

Self-applied tags are chosen by founders, overlap freely at 3.62 per listing, and are not audited by the platform.

One snapshot with no dates. Correlations describe a single moment and support no causal claim about what produced the revenue.

Known defects carried forward: country stores the boolean False for two Norwegian listings, and three duplicate entities inflate total MRR by roughly 0.3%.

All figures recomputed from AI_In_Business_S3_Trust_MRR.xlsx, sheet “Data”, 1,000 rows × 29 columns. No external data used.